

Day 22 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Emergence of Leaders II: Bhagat Singh, Bharathiar, V.O.Chidambaranar, Kamarajar, Periyar, Rajaji, Azad, Tagore

READING MATERIAL

Second 'Emergence of Leaders' topic, covering more Tamil-Nadu-rooted figures plus Bhagat Singh, Azad, and Tagore. Real exam evidence clusters around Periyar and Rajaji specifically via match-the-following formats — a useful signal that TNPSC tests these two especially closely.

Q: Real exam: Which work is associated with Bharathiar (matched correctly in a real exam against several other Tamil literary figures)?

A: Kannan Pattu — one of Bharathiar's most famous poem collections, portraying Lord Krishna in many human relationships (as friend, lover, child, master) as a vehicle for his nationalist and devotional themes.

Q: Real exam: Which journal is associated with Thanthai Periyar, and what social struggle is he specifically noted for in another real exam question?

A: Kudiyarasu (a journal he edited, used to spread his rationalist and Self-Respect Movement ideas). He is separately confirmed in a real exam as the leader who 'fought against patriarchal chauvinism'.

Q: Real exam: Which political party did C. Rajagopalachari (Rajaji) found?

A: The Swatantra Party (a free-market, anti-socialist party he founded after leaving Congress).

Q: What company did V.O. Chidambaranar (V.O.C.) found, and why was it significant?

A: The Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company — founded to challenge British shipping dominance along the Indian coast, a direct economic act of resistance (earning him the title 'Kappalottiya Tamizhan', 'the Tamil helmsman').

Q: What is Kamarajar best known for, both politically and in terms of policy?

A: Known as the 'Kingmaker' in Indian politics (instrumental in selecting Prime Ministers after Nehru). As Tamil Nadu Chief Minister, he strongly promoted education and launched the Midday Meal Scheme to improve school enrollment and child nutrition.

Q: What was Maulana Abul Kalam Azad's key post-independence role, and his role in the freedom struggle?

A: He was independent India's first Education Minister. During the freedom struggle, he was a senior Congress leader and played a key role in the Quit India Movement (1942).

Q: What is Rabindranath Tagore best known for internationally and in India?

A: The first non-European to win the Nobel Prize in Literature (1913, for Gitanjali). He also composed 'Jana Gana Mana', India's national anthem.

Q: What is Bhagat Singh best known for, and how did his execution come about?

A: A member of the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA, formed 1928 with Chandrashekhar Azad, Sukhdev, and Rajguru). He and Rajguru assassinated British police officer J.P. Saunders (December 1928) in revenge for the death of Lala Lajpat Rai. Tried in the Lahore Conspiracy Case, Bhagat Singh, Rajguru, and Sukhdev were executed on 23 March 1931.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Which famous work is associated with Bharathiar?

- A. Pandian Parisu
- B. Kannan Pattu ✓**
- C. Asia Jothi
- D. Tamilan Ithayam

Explanation: Kannan Pattu. [hard, question-bank-2025]

2. Thanthai Periyar is associated with which journal?

- A. Kudiyarasu ✓**
- B. Young India
- C. Harijan
- D. Swadesamitran

Explanation: Kudiyarasu. [medium, question-bank-2024]

3. Periyar is specifically noted, per a real exam question, for fighting against:

A. Colonial taxation

B. Patriarchal chauvinism ✓

C. Foreign trade restrictions

D. Industrial monopolies

Explanation: Patriarchal chauvinism. [medium, question-bank-2025]

4. C. Rajagopalachari (Rajaji) founded which political party?

A. Forward Bloc

B. Justice Party

C. Swatantra Party ✓

D. Swaraj Party

Explanation: Swatantra Party. [medium, question-bank-2024]

5. V.O. Chidambaranar founded which shipping company to challenge British shipping dominance?

A. Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company ✓

B. Tata Shipping Lines

C. Indian Ocean Trading Company

D. Madras Maritime Corporation

Explanation: Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company. [medium, web-research]

6. Kamarajar is best known in Indian politics as the:

A. Father of the Nation

B. Kingmaker ✓

C. Iron Man of India

D. Architect of the Constitution

Explanation: Kingmaker. [medium, web-research]

7. Maulana Abul Kalam Azad served as independent India's first:

A. Prime Minister

B. Education Minister ✓

C. Defence Minister

D. Home Minister

Explanation: Education Minister. [medium, web-research]

8. Rabindranath Tagore won the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1913 for which work?

A. Gora

B. Gitanjali ✓

C. The Home and the World

D. Kabuliwala

Explanation: Gitanjali. [medium, web-research]

9. Bhagat Singh and Rajguru assassinated which British officer in December 1928?

A. James Scott

B. J.P. Saunders ✓

C. Michael O'Dwyer

D. Reginald Dyer

Explanation: J.P. Saunders (mistakenly targeted instead of the intended James Scott). [hard, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Simple Interest

READING MATERIAL

Simple Interest is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows TNPSC favors word-problem variants (doubling time, comparing two loans, fractional rates with month-based time) over the bare 'calculate SI' formula alone.

Q: Formula: What is the Simple Interest formula, and how do you get the doubling time from it?

A: $SI = (\text{Principal} \times \text{Rate} \times \text{Time}) / 100$. A sum DOUBLES when SI equals the Principal itself: $P = (P \times R \times T) / 100 \rightarrow T = 100/R$ years. So at 8% per annum, doubling time = $100/8 = 12.5$ years = 150 months.

Q: Real exam (2024): In how many months will Rs.2,000 double itself at 8% per annum simple interest?

A: $T = 100/R = 100/8 = 12.5$ years = $12.5 \times 12 = 150$ months.

Q: Real exam (2022): What is the simple interest on Rs.1,000 for one year at 10% per annum?

A: $SI = (1000 \times 10 \times 1) / 100 = \text{Rs.}100$.

Q: Real exam (2024): Find the simple interest on Rs.68,000 at $16\frac{2}{3}\%$ per annum for 9 months.

A: Convert the mixed-fraction rate: $16\frac{2}{3}\% = 50/3\%$. Convert months to years: 9 months = $9/12 = 3/4$ year. $SI = 68,000 \times (50/3) \times (3/4) / 100 = 68,000 \times 12.5/100 = \text{Rs.}8,500$. (The 3s cancel neatly between the rate's denominator and the time's numerator — recognizing that shortcut avoids messy fraction arithmetic.)

Q: Real exam (2025): A borrows Rs.16,000 at 12% p.a. simple interest, B borrows Rs.12,000 at 18% p.a. simple interest. In how many years will their total amounts owed (principal+interest) become equal?

A: Set up the equality: $16000 + 16000(0.12)t = 12000 + 12000(0.18)t \rightarrow 16000 + 1920t = 12000 + 2160t \rightarrow 4000 = 240t \rightarrow t = 16\frac{2}{3}$ years.

Q: Method — finding the rate when given principal, time, and final amount: A sum of Rs.5,000 becomes Rs.6,200 in 3 years at simple interest. Find the rate.

A: $SI = \text{Amount} - \text{Principal} = 6200 - 5000 = 1200$. Rearranged formula: $R = (SI \times 100) / (P \times T) = (1200 \times 100) / (5000 \times 3) = 120000/15000 = 8\%$ per annum.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. In how many years will a sum double itself at 5% per annum simple interest?

- A. 10 years
- B. 15 years
- C. 20 years ✓**
- D. 25 years

Explanation: $T = 100/R = 100/5 = 20$ years. [easy, authored]

2. Find the simple interest on Rs.2,500 for 1 year at 12% per annum.

- A. Rs.250
- B. Rs.275
- C. Rs.300 ✓**
- D. Rs.320

Explanation: $SI = (2500 \times 12 \times 1) / 100 = \text{Rs.}300$. [easy, authored]

3. Find the simple interest on Rs.54,000 at $13\frac{1}{3}\%$ per annum for 6 months.

- A. Rs.3,600 ✓**
- B. Rs.3,000
- C. Rs.3,300
- D. Rs.4,000

Explanation: $13\frac{1}{3}\% = 40/3\%$. 6 months = $1/2$ year. $SI = 54000 \times (40/3) \times (1/2) / 100 = 54000 \times 40/600 = 54000 \times (1/15) = 3,600$. [hard, authored]

4. C borrows Rs.20,000 at 10% p.a. simple interest, D borrows Rs.15,000 at 15% p.a. simple interest. In how many years will their total amounts owed become equal?

- A. 8 years
- B. 10 years

C. 20 years ✓

D. 25 years

Explanation: $20000 + 2000t = 15000 + 2250t \rightarrow 5000 = 250t \rightarrow t = 20$ years. [hard, authored]

5. A sum of Rs.8,000 becomes Rs.9,440 in 3 years at simple interest. Find the rate per annum.

A. 5%

B. 6% ✓

C. 6.5%

D. 7%

Explanation: $SI = 9440 - 8000 = 1440$. $R = (1440 \times 100) / (8000 \times 3) = 144000 / 24000 = 6\%$. [medium, authored]

6. What sum will yield Rs.900 as simple interest in 3 years at 6% per annum?

A. Rs.4,000

B. Rs.5,000 ✓

C. Rs.5,500

D. Rs.6,000

Explanation: $P = (SI \times 100) / (R \times T) = (900 \times 100) / (6 \times 3) = 90000 / 18 = \text{Rs.}5,000$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "The Stick-Together Families" — Edgar Albert Guest

READING MATERIAL

Another Edgar Albert Guest poem (his third in this syllabus), arguing that joint/close-knit families are happier than those who scatter in search of external pleasures. Real exam evidence confirms specific quoted lines directly.

Q: What is the poem's central theme?

A: Joint/close-knit ('stick-together') families are happier than those who scatter — there is nothing greater than a happy family gathered together, as opposed to people who wander seeking happiness through 'strange friends' and external pleasures, only to find emptiness.

Q: Real exam: "Come you back unto the fireside and be comrade with your kin." Which poem is this line from?

A: "The Stick-Together Families" — confirmed via a real TNPSC question (2024) that tested this exact quoted line against three other poem-title options.

Q: Real exam: "But the gladdest sort of people, when the busy day is done, are the brothers and the sisters who together share their fun." Who wrote this?

A: Edgar Albert Guest, in "The Stick-Together Families" — confirmed via a real TNPSC question testing this exact line's authorship.

Q: What is the poem's structure (stanzas, lines, rhyme scheme)?

A: Four stanzas of six lines each, rhyme scheme AABBCC (rhyming couplets).

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "The stick-together families are happier by far."

A: Alliteration — repeated initial sounds across the phrase.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "A circle at the fireside that no power but death can break."

A: Metaphor — the family bond is directly described as an unbreakable 'circle', without 'like/as'.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "The finest of conventions ever held beneath the sun."

A: Hyperbole — an exaggerated, absolute claim ('ever', 'beneath the sun') praising the family gathering.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Each goes searching after pleasure in his own selected way."

A: Personification — 'pleasure' is treated as something actively pursued/sought, with people personified as hunters chasing it down individually.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "That the strange friend is the true friend."

A: Irony — directly contradicts the poem's own argument (that close family, not strangers, brings true happiness), used ironically to describe the mistaken belief some people hold.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Come you back unto the fireside and be comrade with your kin" is a line from:

A. Life

B. The Stick-Together Families ✓

C. The Poison Tree

D. The River

Explanation: Confirmed via a real 2024 TNPSC question. [hard, question-bank-2024]

2. "But the gladdest sort of people... are the brothers and the sisters who together share their fun" was written by:

A. D.H. Lawrence

B. William Wordsworth

C. Edgar Albert Guest ✓

D. Mary Botham Howitt

Explanation: Edgar Albert Guest, confirmed via a real 2024 TNPSC question. [hard, question-bank-2024]

3. What is the rhyme scheme of "The Stick-Together Families"?

A. ABAB

B. AABBCC ✓

C. ABCB

D. No fixed rhyme

Explanation: AABBC, rhyming couplets across 6-line stanzas. [hard, web-research]

4. "A circle at the fireside that no power but death can break" uses which figure of speech?

- A. Simile
- B. Personification
- C. Metaphor ✓**
- D. Hyperbole

Explanation: Metaphor — the family bond described directly as an unbreakable circle. [medium, web-research]

5. "The finest of conventions ever held beneath the sun" is an example of:

- A. Simile
- B. Metaphor
- C. Hyperbole ✓**
- D. Alliteration

Explanation: Hyperbole — an exaggerated, absolute claim. [medium, web-research]

6. "That the strange friend is the true friend" is an example of:

- A. Irony ✓**
- B. Simile
- C. Metaphor
- D. Hyperbole

Explanation: Irony — contradicts the poem's own central argument. [medium, web-research]